Checkpoint 2 · Empathy Research & Field Logs

8 User Interviews, AEIOU Observations & Participant Signatures | INT335 Design Thinking

1. Field Participant Roster & Consent Registry

Code	Participant Role	Field Location	Date	Key Incident / Lost Item	Status
S1	Hosteller (B.Tech CSE)	Central Library 2nd Floor	14/09/2026	Casio fx-991EX calculator	Consented
S2	Fresher (Hostel Blk 28)	Block 34 Lobby	15/09/2026	LPU Smart RFID ID Card	Consented
S3	Day Scholar (B.Tech Mech)	UniMall Food Court	16/09/2026	Bike keys with red lanyard	Consented
S4	Day Scholar (B.Tech ECE)	Block 36 Corridor	18/09/2026	Leather wallet & bus pass	Consented
S5	Commuter (B.Tech CSE)	Parking Lot 2	19/09/2026	Charger & bus pass	Consented
S6	Hosteller (1st Yr MBA)	Central Library	20/09/2026	Milton insulated water bottle	Consented
G1	Security Officer Gurpreet	Block 34 Gate Counter	21/09/2026	6 unindexed black umbrellas	Verified
G2	Library Desk Supervisor	Central Library Desk	22/09/2026	Lost calculators in exam week	Verified

2. Deep User Interview Insights (Section 11 Compliant)

Participant S1 (Hosteller, 2nd Year CSE) — *Lost scientific calculator before mid-terms*

"I posted in 4 WhatsApp groups. Someone messaged me trying to claim my calculator just to get a free device. Because I posted a photo showing the front, anyone could claim they were the owner."

Key Design Insight: Open public social broadcasts invite impostor fraud; students need hidden verification proof before handover.

Participant S2 (Fresher Hosteller) — *Lost campus RFID ID card*

"Every guard asked me for proof of identity, but my only identity card was the one I had lost. Without it, I couldn't enter the hostel mess or library for 4 days until re-issue."

Key Design Insight: ID card loss creates an administrative deadlock cutting off food and library access.

Participant S3 (Day Scholar, 3rd Year) — *Found bike keys with lanyard*

"I found bike keys near the stairs. I had class in 5 minutes, so I just left them on the counter. If there were a simple 1-minute way to log it, I would have reported it."

Key Design Insight: Finders face severe time pressures between classes; lack of fast drop channels causes items to be left behind.

Participant G1 (Senior Security Guard Gurpreet Singh) — *Manages physical collection box at Block 34*

"We have a cardboard box full of water bottles, notebooks, and keys under the table. When a student comes asking for a lost black umbrella, I have 6 black umbrellas. Without proof, I cannot give it away."

Key Design Insight: Security staff are overwhelmed by identical items; they urgently need secret distinguishing proof to resolve claims.

3. AEIOU Observational Framework

Dimension	Observed Campus Phenomenon	Design Implication
Activity	Students hurriedly searching desks during the 10-minute lecture interval; guards rummaging through cardboard boxes.	Log entry must take under 60 seconds on mobile.
Environment	600-acre expansive campus with high-traffic nodes: Central Library, Block 34, UniMall, Hostel turnstiles.	Decentralized tagging with specific block/floor coordinates.
Interaction	Awkward interrogations at gate counters; students hesitant to approach security staff.	Standardized secret verification receipt shown on phone screen.
Object	High-loss items: Calculators, RFID ID cards, umbrellas, AirPods, lanyards, gym bottles.	Pre-configured categories with specific trait dropdowns.
User	Hostel students (urgent daily needs), Day scholars (commuter constraints), Security guards (accountability).	Multi-lingual support (7 regional Indian languages) for guards and students.

4. Consolidated User Empathy Map

SAYS
- "I posted my number and got 15 prank calls."
- "Is anyone really going to turn in a Casio calculator?"
- "Guards rotate shifts, so no one knows who took my bag yesterday."

THINKS
- "If I post my contact info, someone will harass me."
- "Whoever found it probably kept it for themselves."
- "Security won't believe it's mine without my ID."

DOES
- Reluctantly posts on chaotic Instagram confession pages.
- Walks 2 km in the heat between Block 34 and Central Library.
- Gives up hope after 48 hours and buys an expensive replacement.

FEELS
- Anxious before midterm exams without necessary tools.
- Vulnerable to fraud and privacy exposure.
- Helpless due to campus scale and lack of communication.